

Zach Vollink

zvollink@gmail.com | 616-550-2266 | www.linkedin.com/in/zachvollink/

Summary

Dynamic Frontend Engineer with 10+ years shipping polished, user-obsessed web products. Deep expertise in React and TypeScript, and a BFA in Graphic Design that means I notice design issues other engineers overlook — I generally know when something feels off before I can articulate why. I've built for audiences from 50k to 1.5M users, owned projects end-to-end as a freelance consultant, and thrive in fast-moving environments where shipping and learning from real users matters more than perfecting in isolation. Especially motivated by products that respect the people who use them.

Professional Experience

Senior Frontend Engineer | State of Michigan - DTMB Grand Rapids/Lansing, MI | December 2024 - Present

Architect and develop production React applications across multiple enterprise-scale projects serving Michigan state agencies and their constituents, maintaining high standards for performance, accessibility, and code quality.

Manage sprint workflows and frontend-backend coordination in Azure DevOps within an Agile delivery environment, navigating complex dependency chains across distributed teams.

The go-to frontend specialist on the floor — sought out for UI architecture decisions and component design, and tapped cross-project to lead accessibility remediation across all CDS applications.

Built a shared react-select wrapper component — fully ADA compliant and styled to Digital Guidelines specs — standardizing Autocomplete and Multiselect implementations across all CDS projects and resolving long-standing accessibility gaps.

Mentor a junior frontend developer through code reviews and pair programming, establishing frontend best practices adopted across teams — resulting in a developer who now independently champions code quality standards in meetings and architecture discussions.

Pushed to formalize frontend development guidelines across the department, advocating for dedicated frontend hiring and higher engineering standards on a team with limited frontend specialization.

Frontend Engineer | Bitsbox Boulder, CO | November 2016 - July 2024

Bridged the gap between design and development, translating wireframes into user-friendly and functional web pages in collaboration with designers, marketing, and operation leads.

Crafted responsive and accessible UIs for Bitsbox and two of their key partners, STEMscopes and Highlights Kids. Leveraging HTML, CSS, and JavaScript, I ensured a seamless experience for over 1.5 million users across any device, including 500k Bitsbox users, 50k STEMscopes students, and more than one million Highlights subscribers.

Delivered high-performing web experiences utilizing Google Cloud Functions. Key achievements include automating cancellations, saving the support team 30 seconds per cancellation (~1200 man hours per year), accelerating shipment processing, dynamically serving social and SEO meta tags for Bitsbox user pages, and managing users' custom images.

Led project to enhance user experience and system efficiency by merging child coding accounts with adult subscription accounts through extensive whiteboarding and database design discussions. This improved the parents' user experience dramatically by giving them more control over their kids' coding accounts, letting them have multiple child accounts under the umbrella parental account, and enabling a password reset option for kids accounts that goes to the parents email.

Managed data flows and integrated external APIs including Google's Place Autocomplete API, to streamline address completion at checkout. Oversaw data transfer between front-end and back-end systems using data-manager scripts and Google Cloud functions, and utilized Zapier Webhooks to handle responses from API calls on Bitsbox's platform, enabling seamless integration with third-party apps to meet business needs.

Championed code quality by writing and maintaining unit tests, conducting regular code reviews, and upholding high coding standards within Agile frameworks. Actively contributed to sprint planning and retrospectives, fostering a collaborative team environment. Embraced continuous improvement by adopting emerging technologies, Agile best practices, and industry trends to enhance productivity and deliver high-quality, iterative solutions

GUI Developer | CU*Answers Grand Rapids, MI | May 2014 - August 2016

Responsible for developing and maintaining GUI panels for core and custom screens, as well as developing XML scripts and program code to extend the base functionality of the company's core software product.

Worked with interdisciplinary teams to assess client needs, determine project requirements, and iteratively develop the GUI to meet those specifications.

Projects

Skoolie Locker Rentals: Built a single-page application (SPA) using React for a local mobile locker business, leveraging Vercel for deployment, Tailwind CSS for styling, and Google Analytics for performance tracking.

EverIn: Developing an iOS/Android compatible app using React Native for recommending restaurants to friends and family. The app, still in early development, features Firebase authentication, user data management, and route handling based on authentication status.

Healthy Roof: Currently building a custom Next.js site for a roofing company, migrating them off Squarespace to a more professional web presence designed to attract new clients.

Woodwork by Case: Designing and shipping a Next.js portfolio site for a carpentry business, deployed on Vercel with Tailwind.

Skills

- **Languages:** Typescript, JavaScript, Python, HTML/CSS
- **Frameworks/Libraries:** React, React Native (Expo), Next.js, Tailwind CSS, Sass
- **Miscellaneous:** Vercel, Google Cloud Platform
- **Content Management Systems:** Firebase, WordPress
- **API Integrations:** RESTful APIs
- **Tools:** Figma, Adobe CC Suite, VSC, Warp, Sourcetree
- **Pixels & Growth:** Google Analytics, Google Tag Manager, CrazyEgg, Hotjar, Zapier, Mailchimp
- **Essential Skills:** Collaboration, Problem Solving, Communication, Adaptability, Creativity

Education

Bachelor of Fine Arts in Graphic Design Northern Michigan University | Graduated 2014

Web Design Internship | La Dolce Video & Design Marquette, MI | 2013 - 2014

Zeitgeist Senior Exhibition | DeVos Art Museum NMU School of Art and Design | 2014

Awards

Eagle Scout Rank

Eagle Scout Project: Built a 12x30' deck for the Camp Roger Nature Center in Rockford, MI. Secured funding via donations for supplies, recruited and coordinated volunteers, and teamed up with the grounds manager to complete the project efficiently.

Additional Information

Volunteering: West Michigan Mountain Biking Association Trail Adopter.

Hobbies: Lifelong gamer (tabletop, video, D&D), mountain biking, snowboarding, being outdoors, home improvements, and nerding out on new tech.